

LRRA Website Discovery & UX Requirements

Lakes Region Repeater Association — W1BST

Proposed website redesign

1. Purpose

The goal of the redesign is to make the LRRA website easier to understand, navigate, and use—particularly for people who are unfamiliar with amateur radio.

LRRA has a substantial amount of valuable information. The challenge is organizing that information so visitors can quickly find what they need without having to understand the organization or its terminology first.

The proposed redesign will preserve that information while creating a clearer path through the site.

2. Primary Audiences

The redesigned site should serve five primary groups:

- **Licensed hams** looking for repeater frequencies, tones, coverage, links, and net information.
- **Club members and local operators** looking for meetings, breakfasts, nets, Field Day, Hamfest, newsletters, and other activities.
- **Newcomers** considering an amateur-radio license or looking for a place to get started.
- **Technical volunteers** interested in repeaters, towers, equipment, infrastructure, and upgrades.
- **Emergency partners** including ARES, event organizers, and local agencies.

3. What Should Visitors Be Able to Do?

The site should make these actions obvious:

1. **Get on the air** — find frequencies, tones, links, coverage, and net information.
2. **Get involved** — learn how to join, get licensed, attend an event, or participate in a net.
3. **Understand LRRA** — quickly learn who the organization is and why it matters to the Lakes Region.

4. **Support LRRA** — pay dues, donate, or participate in equipment-related activities.
5. **Contact a person** — find a straightforward way to reach someone at the club.

4. Information Priorities

The proposed content hierarchy is:

1. How to get on the air

This is particularly important because visitors arriving through the W1BST callsign are likely looking for repeater information.

2. How to join, get licensed, or participate

Make testing, membership, events, breakfasts, and nets easy to find.

3. Who LRRA is and why it matters

Communicate the club's local presence, 50-year history, emergency-communications role, and openness to newcomers without overwhelming visitors with information.

4. Supporting the organization

Make dues, donations, and used equipment accessible without allowing them to dominate the visitor experience.

5. Contact

Provide one clear path to reach a person.

5. Current User Experience Challenges

The existing site contains a great deal of useful material, but the homepage and navigation can make important tasks difficult to discover.

The redesign should address several issues:

- **The homepage should function as a front door**, rather than primarily as a stream of news, articles, announcements, and other material.
- **Repeater information should be easier to use**, rather than requiring visitors to piece together frequencies, links, coverage, and other information.
- **Joining and getting licensed should have clear paths** rather than relying on visitors to infer where to begin.

- **The navigation and language should accommodate newcomers**, not assume that every visitor already understands amateur-radio terminology.
- **Current information should be easy to maintain and keep accurate.**

6. Attracting New and Younger Members

"Attracting younger members" should ultimately be about **visitor behavior**, rather than simply adding younger-oriented content or social-media links.

A successful visitor experience should allow someone to:

Understand in 10 seconds

This is a local New Hampshire radio club that maintains a public network and helps people learn amateur radio.

See themselves in the organization

Show the range of activities—Field Day, public-service events, building and maintaining equipment, meetings, and social activities.

Take one low-friction action

Come to breakfast, listen to or participate in a net, inquire about testing, or learn how to join.

Come back with a reason

Find an upcoming event, program a radio, check repeater information, or participate in club activities.

Social media such as TikTok can support this strategy, but it should complement—not replace—the core website experience.

7. Proposed Design Direction

The redesign will emphasize:

- **A clear, welcoming homepage**
- Simplified primary navigation
- Logical organization of existing content
- Prominent paths for newcomers and prospective members
- Practical repeater information
- Current news and events without overwhelming the homepage
- Responsive design for phones, tablets, and desktop computers
- Clear calls to action

- A visual identity that feels current while retaining LRRRA's established identity

8. Next Steps

The next stage of the project is to translate these findings into the site's **information architecture and user experience**:

1. Audit and categorize existing content.
2. Develop a simplified sitemap.
3. Map key visitor/user flows.
4. Create wireframes for the most important pages.
5. Develop the visual UI direction.
6. Build and test a working WordPress prototype.

The objective is not to discard LRRRA's existing information, but to organize it around the needs and expectations of the people visiting the site.